

The comparison here is regarding the file content search capability, not the filename search capability.

### 4.3.1 Google Desktop Search (<http://desktop.google.co.in>)

Searching through files was considered the purview of the operating system till Google decided to train its search engine to look for



Google search results

local files. Google Desktop Search (GDS) is for those who are not satisfied with their existing operating system's capabilities in this domain.

Like the online version, there are two components to GDS. The search box forms the front end, which gets results from a database that is maintained by a Crawler that goes around the system indexing data. Until the crawler does a complete indexing of the files the search results will not be complete. In fact, if you try to search just after installing GDS, there will be no results at all. GDS uses the default browser to display results and to configure the engine. This Web page resembles the usual search page at google.com, except that the address bar contains the local address—127.0.0.1.

Google indexes files in the background when the system is idle; the indexed results are stored locally, and take up a few MB of disk space. Users can configure the areas where GDS should or shouldn't index, but otherwise they cannot directly control the indexing process. The status of the indexing process can be seen by accessing "Index Status" option from the System Tray icon.

Off the shelf, GDS can index quite a few file content types like text, Word documents, Excel sheets, Web documents, PDFs, etc. located anywhere on the system including the browser cache. And this capability can be enhanced by the installation of plugins